



PORTAL GUIDE

LittleSteps User Manual

A practical guide for parents, educators, principals, district users and administrators.

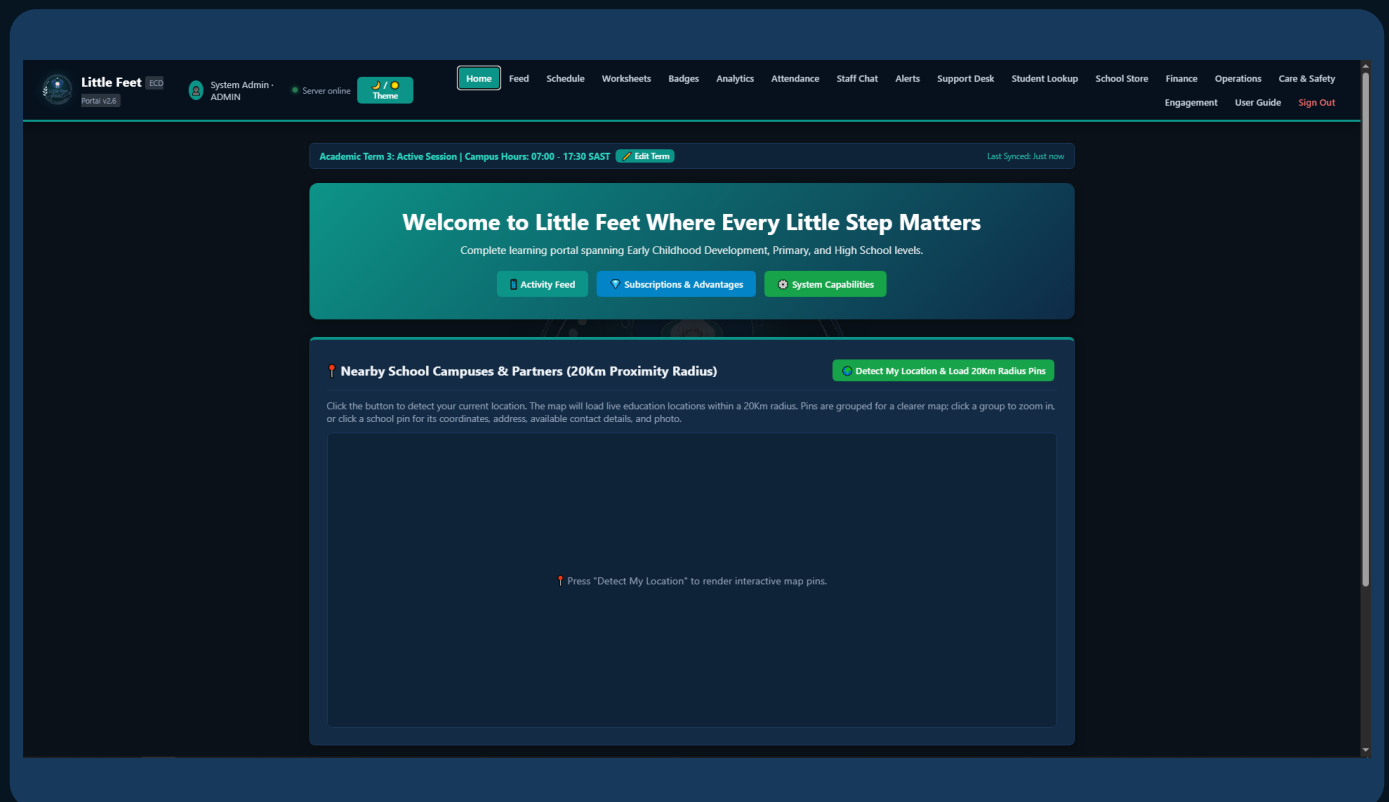
Start here

- **Sign in securely** Use your approved staff ID or parent email and password/PIN. Keep the device-save option enabled only on a personal, protected device.
- **Choose your role** Your school link, role and subscription decide which tabs are visible. Ask an administrator or use self-registration if your account is not yet created.
- **Read notices** The Terms and Privacy notice explains the school's data-use expectations. Review it before continuing and update consent choices when your circumstances change.
- **Use the tab view** On a phone or tablet, use the compact menu to reach every available section. On large screens, the same tabs remain in the header.

Quick support

If the portal shows an unexpected error, open Support Desk. The report includes a plain-language summary and relevant technical reference for the school support team; do not paste sensitive child data into a support ticket.

Home and navigation



- **Home** Start with session information, notices, the optional nearby-school map and shortcuts to the most-used functions.
- **Nearby schools** Choose Detect My Location only when you consent to use location. Pins are grouped for clarity; public contact details may be incomplete when the source does not publish them.
- **Service indicator** The header uses green for online, yellow for slow/traffic conditions, and red for offline. It is an operational status cue, not a guarantee of service availability.

Schedules and learning records

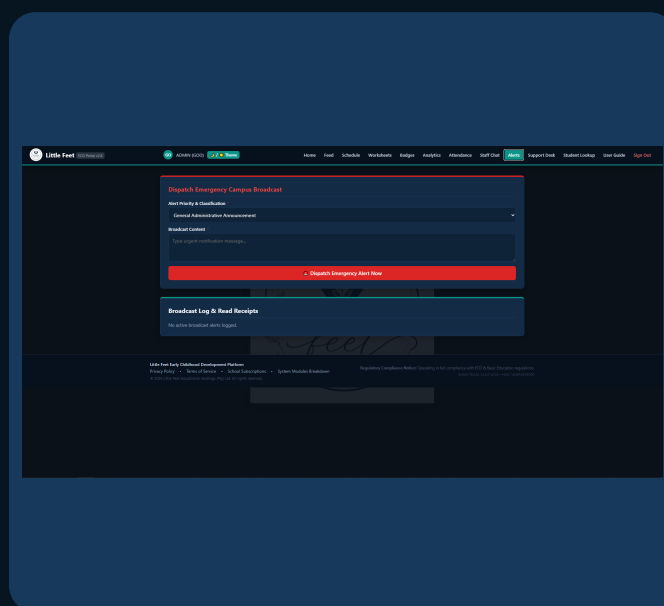
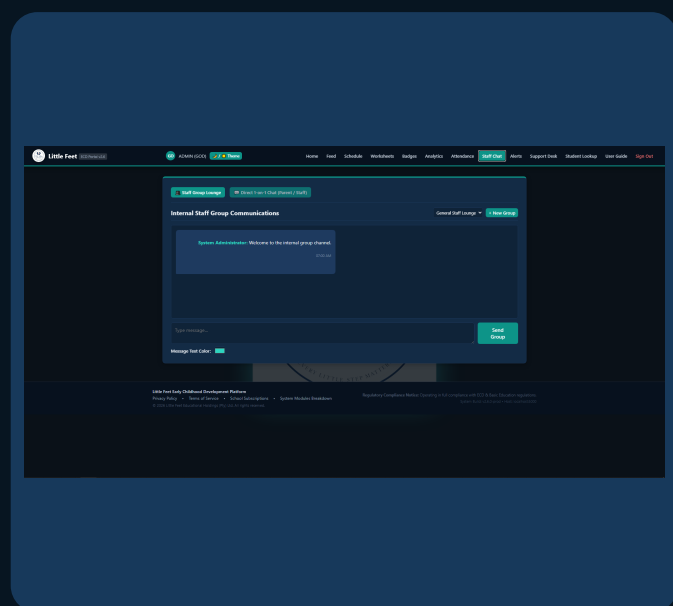
The screenshot displays the 'Create learner schedule' form and the 'Schedule records' section. The form includes fields for 'Full Student Name' (e.g., Liam Smith), 'Day of Week' (Monday), 'Time Slot Block' (e.g., 09:00 AM - 10:00 AM), and 'Activity / Lesson Module' (e.g., Fine Motor Skills & Painting). A 'Save schedule entry' button is at the bottom. The 'Schedule records' section has a 'Download import template' button, an 'Import schedule template (Excel .xlsx or .csv)' field with a 'No file chosen' message, an 'Import schedule' button, and a message stating 'No active schedule records found.'.

- **Create a schedule** Select the learner, day, time block and activity, then save. Use consistent activity names so reporting remains clear.
- **Use a template** Download the schedule template, complete it in a spreadsheet, then import it. Export current schedules when you need a review copy.
- **Record learning** Add worksheets, observations, milestone tags and appropriate photo evidence only for children you are authorised to view.
- **Share reports safely** Publish a report for the linked parent. Teacher and parent signatures, protected by separate PINs, are required before final completion.

Attendance, care and progress

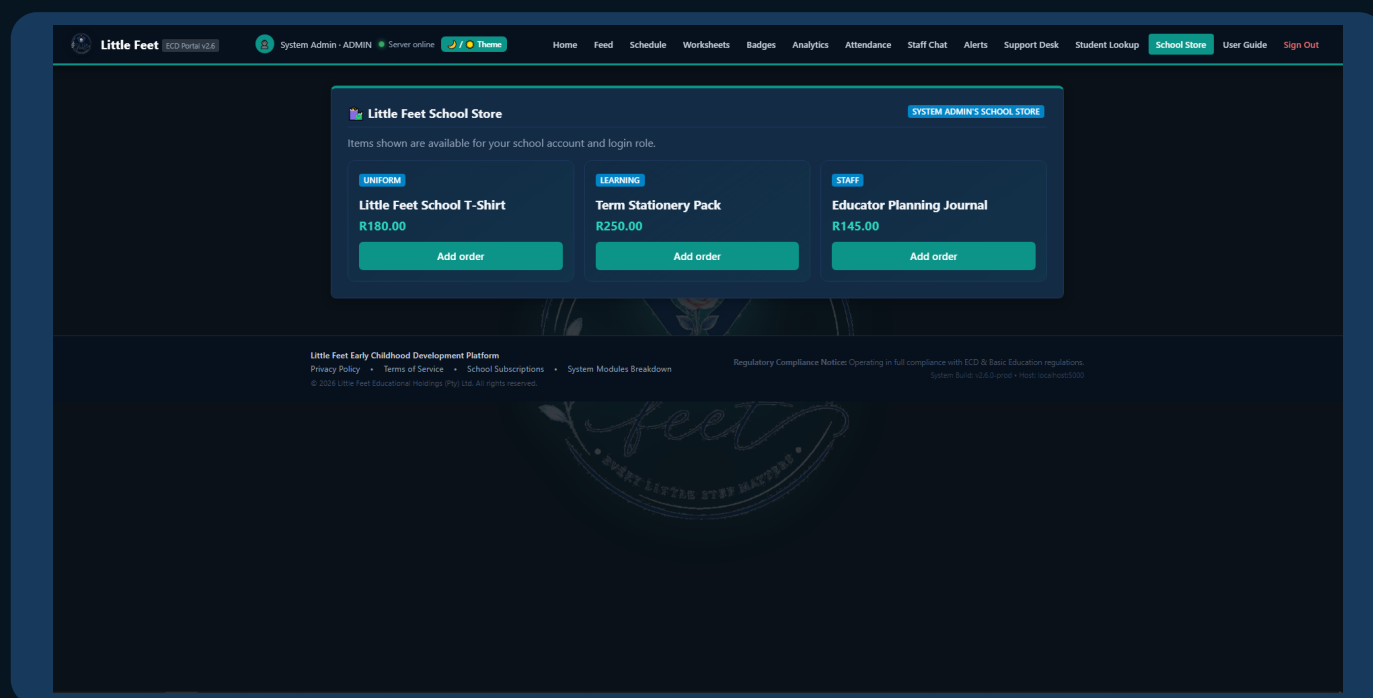
- **Attendance** Record check-in and check-out with the correct learner name. Use the import template for an approved roster; review the daily registry before clearing anything.
- **Daily care** Use one-tap logs for meals, naps, mood, toileting/diaper checks and care notes. Record factual, respectful information only.
- **Medical and safety** Check allergy cards and authorised pickup details before care or dismissal. Medication requires the school's required approval and staff sign-off process.
- **Analytics** Select the child and calculate metrics to compare recorded results. The view highlights percentage movement and best/worst assessed results; detailed analytics are shown only when the parent subscription permits them.
- **Reports by month** Store work and reports against the correct month so families and teachers can locate an accurate history later.

Communication and alerts



- **Staff chat** Select the group or direct conversation, write a concise message and send. Keep child-sensitive details within approved school channels.
- **Broadcast alerts** Choose the alert type, audience and area carefully. Area-aware alerts are intended for users within the configured area, with a short sound cue for urgency.
- **Notice board** Read new portal updates and school announcements. You can close optional advice banners; the portal remembers the dismissal preference.
- **Support desk** Create a ticket when help is needed and include the screen, action and time. Avoid passwords, ID numbers and medical details in the message.

School services and administration



- **School store** This area is specific to the school linked to your account. If no store URL or catalogue is configured, the portal displays that the school has no web store.
- **Account management** Administrators can create accounts, connect them to a school, set a role, change a display name, deactivate access and review records.
- **Self-registration** Parents, teachers and principals can request an account from the login screen. An authorised school administrator should verify the link before sensitive access is granted.
- **Operations** Finance, stock intake, resources, safeguarding, progress and engagement tools should be used only by staff whose role gives them access.

Privacy, safety and consent

- **Consent first** Only publish a child's media or learning update within the consent choices recorded for that family. Internal class updates and marketing imagery are separate decisions.
- **Keep information private** Do not share login details, export records without authority, or expose another family's information in messages, reports or incident records.
- **Protect pickup** Confirm the approved pickup adult and use the configured PIN/QR verification process. Escalate uncertainty to a manager before releasing a child.
- **Write objective records** Incident notes should describe what happened, what care was provided, and the next action. Do not include another child's identifying information.
- **Know the limits** The portal supports POPIA- and Children's Act-aware workflows, but each school remains responsible for legal review, training, security configuration, retention policy and incident response.

Phone, tablet and shared screen use

- **Phone** Use the compact tab menu, work one card at a time, and rotate to landscape only where a table or signature box needs more space.
- **Tablet** Use templates for fast classroom entry. Keep the device locked between learners and ensure signatures are completed by the authorised adult.
- **TV or shared display** Use the home dashboard, notices and non-sensitive schedules. Avoid displaying child records, contact details, alerts or medical information on public screens.
- **Accessibility** Use clear labels, high contrast mode where available, and larger browser text. Tell the school if an important task cannot be completed accessibly.

Before you leave

Save your work, sign out on shared devices, and report any unexpected access or data issue through Support Desk immediately.

Common questions

- **I cannot see a tab** Your role, school link or subscription may not include it. Ask an administrator to check your account rather than using another person's login.
- **A report will not complete** Confirm that the teacher and parent have each entered their own PIN and drawn their signature. Refresh only after saving the current work.
- **The school map is slow** Location lookup and public map data can take time. Reduce the map area, wait for the status message, or try again on a stable connection.
- **I need technical help** Open Support Desk. If the portal detects an application error, it can direct you there with a support reference and relevant context for the school's technical team.
- **Who owns the data?** The school is responsible for its learner and family data. Follow the school's privacy notice, consent settings and retention policy.

Need help? Start with Support Desk or your school administrator.